CORESTONE
DEVELOPERS

A CORESTONE GUIDE

The 2026 Sullivan County Build Cost Guide

Real numbers for custom homes from $500K to $3M



SULLIVAN COUNTY, NEW YORK

2026 EDITION

START HERE

How to read this guide

These are real 2026 ranges for custom builds in Sullivan County, NY, based on actual project costs. Every build is different, but if a builder won't show you numbers in these ranges, ask why.

PART ONE

Land: $50K to $500K+

The lot sets the ceiling for everything after it.

Wooded interior lots, 2 to 10 acres	$50K to $150K
Elevated lots with long views	$150K to $300K
Lakefront or significant water frontage	$250K to $500K+

What moves a lot up in price

Views, water, privacy (no visible neighbors), southern exposure, existing driveway or cleared areas.

PART TWO

Site work: $40K to $200K

This is the number that surprises first-time builders most.

ITEM	TYPICAL RANGE
Clearing and grading	$15K to $50K
Driveway Long rural driveways add up fast	$15K to $60K
Well	$8K to $15K
Septic Engineered or raised systems run higher	$15K to $45K
Electric run to the site Depending on distance	$5K to $25K

ROUGH RULE

Budget 10 to 15 percent of construction cost for site work, more if the lot is steep, rocky, or far off the road.

PART THREE

Construction cost per square foot, by finish level

This is the core of the guide. Three tiers:

Quality custom

$300 to $400

per sqft

Real hardwood or high-end LVP, quartz counters, quality appliances, good windows, thoughtful lighting. A genuinely nice home. Most production-adjacent custom builds land here.

High-end

$450 to $600

per sqft

Wide-plank floors, stone counters, premium appliance packages, custom millwork in key rooms, better window packages, landscape lighting, outdoor living space designed in from the start.

Luxury

$650 to $900+ per sqft

Everything above, plus: full custom millwork, stone or exotic tile throughout, professional-grade kitchens, spa bathrooms, smart home infrastructure, walls of glass, complex rooflines, high-end exterior materials (cedar, stone, standing seam).

PART FOUR

Three real scenarios

The $650K build

LIVING SPACE	BUILD RATE	LOT & SITE
2,000 sqft	~$325 / sqft	Modest, simple

2,000 sqft at roughly $325 per sqft. Quality custom finishes, straightforward roofline, modest lot with simple site work. Comfortable, well-built, no wasted space.

The $1.5M build

LIVING SPACE	BUILD RATE	LOT	SITE WORK
3,000 sqft	~$500 / sqft	$200K view lot	$100K

3,000 sqft at roughly $500 per sqft. High-end finishes throughout, view lot at $200K, $100K in site work. This is the sweet spot for a serious second home.

The $3M build

LIVING SPACE	BUILD RATE	LOT	SITE WORK
4,200 sqft	~$700 / sqft	$350K+ premium	$150K

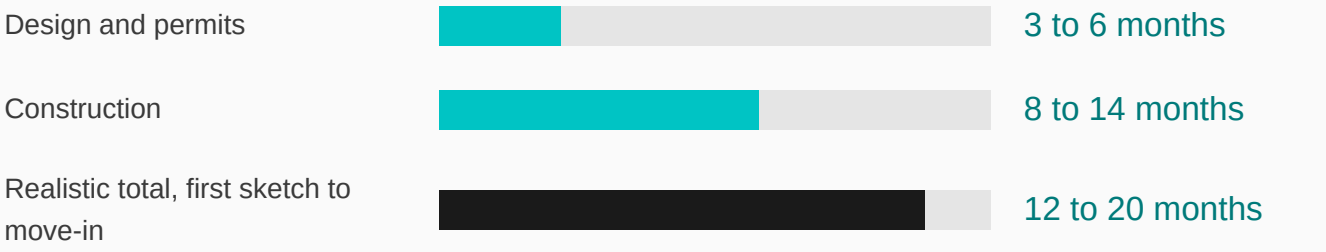
4,200 sqft at roughly $700 per sqft. Luxury everything, premium lot with water or long views at $350K+, $150K site work. Walls of glass, custom everything, built to be photographed.

PART FIVE

What drives cost up the most, ranked

1. Finish level. The jump from quality to luxury finishes can double the per-sqft number.
2. Structural complexity. Every corner, cantilever, and glass wall costs money.
3. Site conditions. Rock, slope, and wetlands show up in site work, not in the per-sqft quote. Always ask about them separately.
4. Changes mid-build. The most expensive words in construction are "while we're at it."

Permits and timeline



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CUSTOM HOME BUILDERS

THE QUESTION THIS GUIDE CAN'T ANSWER

Numbers get you oriented. They don't get you a home. The next step is a conversation about your lot, your timeline, and what you actually want to wake up to every morning.

TALK TO CORESTONE

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